



City Council June 1, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mxl_QVvK5Lg
Publication Date	2026-06-02T13:57:43Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Common Council

Meeting Date: June 1, 2026

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Public Hearing on Additional Appropriations for Public Safety
[00:00:08](#)
- **Summary of Discussion:**
 - The council opened a public hearing to consider Ordinance 10-26 (Muncie Police Department appropriations) and Ordinance 11-26 (Muncie Fire Department appropriations).
 - Public commenters expressed confusion and concern over why additional funding requests of roughly \$5 million were appearing months after the initial budget, questioning line items like retirement funds (PERF) and capital expenditures.
 - Fire Chief Dan Berford spoke during the hearing to clarify that these ordinances do not represent new, additional spending requests from the departments. Rather, they are correction measures for Funds 105 and 106 (Local Income Tax funds) that were dropped or lost through the state's "Gateway" software during the initial budget process, reverting lines back to what was originally discussed and approved during budget hearings last fall.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Green called the regular meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order on June 1, 2026 00:20:16.
 - **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Dishman, Missy, Mr. Macintosh, Mr. Mason, Mr. Garrett, Mian (Golian), Mr. Bash, and President Green. (*Note: Roll call confirms a full complement of council members present.*)
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Green.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:15:25.
 - An invocation was delivered by Dr. Kip Taylor 00:15:35.
 - Citizen recognition for May 2026 was presented by Councilman Jerry Dishman to Vicky Beach, a long-time community leader, former executive director of the Muncie Visitors Bureau, and coordinator of events such as the Summer Heat Hot Air Balloon Festival and downtown revitalization events 00:16:21.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Approved by roll call vote (unanimous affirmative) 00:20:30.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Appointments to Boards and Commissions

- **Human Rights Commission:**
 - Nominations were made for Linda Pong Benner (nominated by President Green) and Daisy Dale (nominated by Councilwoman Powell) 00:21:00, 00:23:35.
 - Following public remarks and candidate statements, a roll call vote resulted in the appointment of **Daisy Dale** 00:28:13.
- **Muncie Animal Care Services:**
 - Nominations were held for two openings, including a required veterinarian 00:29:04.
 - Dr. Andy Fipp (Maplewood Animal Hospital) was nominated as the veterinarian, and Haley Perkins (current board president) was nominated for reappointment [00:29:31, 00:30:11].
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (unanimous affirmative) 00:30:38.
- **Muncie School Community Board:**
 - A late nomination was brought forward to reappoint Watasha Barn Griffith to the Muncie School Community Board prior to the state deadline [00:42:01,

00:44:54].

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote 00:45:54.

Committee Reports

- **Community Youth Center Committee Report:** Delivered by Council Person Macintosh 00:31:21.
 - Reported on the committee's first meeting on May 21, 2026, where officers were elected (Jasmine Taylor, President; Leslie McCroy, Vice President; Courtney Marsh, Secretary).
 - Raised significant concerns that the administration had already predetermined site locations (such as a vacant building on Mock Street / Industry Methodist Church) and operational partnerships (Brothers to Brothers) prior to committee input, sidelining the goal of placing a new community center back in the Industry neighborhood where it was originally promised. Multiple council members weighed in to express support for returning the center to the Industry neighborhood.

Ordinances & Resolutions

- **00:46:34 Ordinance 9-26: Ordinance Approving Matters Related to Lease Financing of Fire Station Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bond counsel (Dennis from Bose McKenna and Evans) and financial advisors.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council members raised questions regarding inaccuracies on the ordinance's introductory pages (regarding investigations and cost estimates) and questioned why the city shifted from a Build-Operate-Transfer (BOT) model to lease financing. Bond counsel explained that lease financing is a standard tool necessitated by the city's constitutional debt capacity limits following previous station builds, and that a separate BOT procurement hearing will still occur.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Residents criticized the procedural rollout, questioned the emergency borrowing around debt limits, and urged fiscal prudence.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Initially introduced via roll call 01:05:34, followed immediately by a successful motion and roll call vote to **refer Ordinance 9-26 to the Public Services Committee** for further review 01:06:06.
- **01:06:46 Ordinance 10-26: Additional Appropriations - Muncie Police Department**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Controller's office representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Clarified as a housekeeping measure to correct line items (Fund 106 Local Income Tax) dropped by state software (Gateway) during the prior budget cycle, rather than new spending.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call 01:10:13.
- **01:10:43 Ordinance 11-26: Additional Appropriations - Muncie Fire Department**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fire Chief Dan Berford.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed Fund 105 LIT corrections alongside a mandated state pension contribution increase moving from 20.3% to 23.3%.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call [01:14:02](#).
- **[01:14:21](#) Ordinance 12-26: Zoning Amendment from R2 Residence Zone to BV Variety Business Zone (4,600 N. Wheeling Ave.)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Warner (Studio 22) and real estate representatives; received a favorable recommendation from the Plan Commission [01:14:50](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed the proposed rezoning to allow a personal training and health business to expand across the street into a long-vacant church property. Council noted that the BV zone protects the surrounding residential area from detrimental heavy commercial uses.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Long-term clients and community members testified to the high operating standards of Studio 22 and the community health benefits.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [01:23:00](#).
- **[01:29:26](#) Resolution 8-26: Resolution Authorizing an Investigation into the Financial Operations and Internal Controls of the City Controller's Office**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilwoman Nora Powell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Intended as a fact-finding review of State Board of Accounts audit findings and repeated internal control deficiencies (dating from 2020 to 2025) rather than a search for malfeasance. After a failed motion to table [01:36:46](#), the council debated and adopted three major amendments:
 1. Excluding law enforcement investigatory records, criminal work products, and prosecutor communications to ensure no interference with ongoing criminal investigations [01:30:31](#).
 2. Striking specific references to the Parks and Recreation special investigation report [01:31:10](#).
 3. Mandating that the review be conducted by the complete council rather than a subset committee [01:45:31](#).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Heavy public testimony overwhelmingly urged the council to pass the resolution, emphasizing that oversight of internal controls and corrective action plans is a core statutory duty of the legislative body.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted as amended by Roll Call Vote [02:06:54](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **[02:10:24](#) Mr. Christopher Bilbury:** Discussed open-door violations filed with the Public Access Counselor regarding prior council meetings, criticized meeting procedures, and urged council members to carefully weigh running for reelection.
- **[02:13:38](#) Mr. Wayne Sharpe:** Raised questions regarding the 8th member added to the Youth Center committee without clear authorization, criticized the selection of the Mock

Street church site outside the Industry neighborhood, and commented on committee structures.

- **02:16:26 Mr. Rob Miller:** Announced a capital campaign by the Muncie Central Neighborhood Association to repair the Emily Kimbro House and encouraged community donations to secure matching state funds (muny-ecn.org).
- **02:17:43 Willow Craig (Student/Resident):** Spoke on community cleanups, noted the lack of visible council participation, and encouraged officials to actively engage in neighborhoods.
- **02:20:38 Mr. Norman Hawkins:** Voiced opposition to the proposed community center location, emphasizing that a center was promised specifically to the Industry neighborhood (suggesting Hein Park or Sutton School property).
- **02:22:53 Ms. Leslie McCroy:** Read a statement announcing her resignation from the Community Youth Center Steering Committee, citing that administrative decisions had already predetermined the Mock Street location, bypassing genuine community input and failing to fulfill the promise made to the Industry neighborhood.
- **02:27:21 Ms. Janetta Presley:** Raised concerns regarding the allocation and planning of opioid settlement funds, arguing that community input was bypassed in favor of pre-determined administrative plans.
- **02:29:18 Mr. Paul Partisana:** Addressed community progress regarding the former Borg Warner site corridor and praised youth civic engagement.
- **02:31:26 Ms. Courtney Marsh:** Echoed concerns regarding the Community Youth Center committee process, noting that key decisions regarding the site had been made behind closed doors prior to committee empowerment.
- **02:35:56 Ms. Jasmine Taylor:** As newly elected president of the Community Youth Center steering committee and an Industry resident, emphasized survey data showing overwhelming neighborhood desire for a community center directly in the Industry footprint.
- **02:38:40 Additional Public Comment:** Addressed follow-up on a prior month's report regarding residential water access, announced upcoming "Know Your Rights" safety trainings at the Muncie Liberation Studio (held the first Wednesday of each month at 7:00 PM), and wished the community a Happy Pride Month **02:40:03**.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Councilwoman Nora Powell read a formal inquiry statement regarding the status of stalled 2026 collective bargaining agreements and wage adjustments for AFSCME Local 3656 employees **02:07:26**.
- **Adjournment:** Upon a motion duly made and seconded, the meeting was adjourned by voice vote (Aye) **02:40:37**.

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